

SIMILE

Comparing two things using "like" or "as"



1 What is it?

Simile (SIM-uh-lee)

A simile compares two *different* things by saying one is **like** or **as** the other — to help the reader picture something more clearly, or feel something stronger.

thing A + **LIKE / AS** + thing B

2 See it in action

Feeling brave

She was as brave as a lion walking into the exam.

Describing speed

He ran like the wind, chasing the bus down the street.

Setting a mood

The old house was as quiet as a graveyard at midnight.

In song lyrics

"Life is like a box of chocolates" — you never know what you'll get.



Mfalme says...

Spotting the words "**like**" or "**as**" is your fastest clue — but watch out, not every "like" is a simile (Section 2 on page 2 will show you why)!

FUN FACT

Similes are one of the **oldest** tricks in storytelling — Homer's *Iliad*, written thousands of years ago, is full of them: warriors charge "like lions," and armies move "like swarms of bees."

3 Why writers use it

Simile helps writers: paint a picture in the reader's mind, make ordinary descriptions more powerful, add emotion or atmosphere, and connect a new idea to something the reader already knows and feels.

A good simile doesn't just describe — it makes you *feel* the description. Comparing fear to "a bird trapped in a cage" says more than just "she felt scared."

4 Don't mix it up!

Simile

- Uses **like** or **as**
- "Her smile was **like** sunshine."
- Says two things are *similar*

Metaphor

- No **like** or **as**
- "Her smile **was** sunshine."
- Says one thing *IS* the other



Watch out!

Not every "like" is a simile! "I **like** chocolate" is just the verb *like* — no comparison happening. A simile always compares **two things** using like/as.



Look here!

When you spot a simile in your reading, ask: "**What two things are being compared, and why did the writer pick THOSE two things?**" That's where the real analysis marks come from.

5 Quick recap

Compares two different things

Uses **like** or **as**

Creates a picture or feeling



You got this!

Next time you write, try swapping a plain description for a simile — "the sky was grey" becomes "the sky was **as grey as** wet concrete." Small change, big impact.